

CAPABILITY $\neq$ AUTHORITY



AI ADOPTION IS ACCELERATING.
Enterprise AI maturity is not.



THAT GAP IS WHERE RISK LIVES.
And with Agentic AI, the stakes are higher.



AN AGENT MAY BE CAPABLE
of taking an action.
That does not mean it should have
the authority to take it.



THE REAL QUESTION IS NOT:
"Can the AI do it?"
It is:

“Who authorized it, within
what boundary, with what
evidence—and can that
authority be enforced and
revoked?”



**BECAUSE RESPONSIBLE AGENTIC AI IS NOT JUST ABOUT
WHAT AI CAN DO.
IT IS ABOUT PROVING WHAT AI IS ALLOWED TO DO.**

THE ASSURANCE CHAIN FOR CONTROLLED AI EXECUTION

Aligned with The I-A-N-E-T-F Cone Framework™ (Internal Audit Assurance Chain)



1 INTENT

Clearly define the
purpose, objective,
and scope of the
AI action.

No intent,
no legitimacy.



2 AUTHORITY

Establish who has
the authority to
authorize the action
at the relevant
decision boundary.

Authority must be
explicit, appropriate
and documented.



3 ENFORCEMENT

Ensure the boundary
is enforced by
architecture,
controls and
circuit breakers.

Policy without
enforcement is
a false control.



4 EVIDENCE

Capture immutable
evidence of the
decision, data,
context and
rationale.

If it isn't evidenced,
it didn't happen.



5 TESTING

Independently test
whether the boundary
works as designed
under real-world
conditions.

Assurance comes
from testing,
not trusting.



6 FORENSIC

Maintain forensic
ready records to
reconstruct, review,
and take action
when required.

Accountability is
proven in hindsight,
not claimed in
advance.



**THE ULTIMATE QUESTION IS NOT WHAT THE AGENT CAN DO.
IT IS WHAT THE AGENT IS AUTHORIZED TO DO—AND CAN THE
ENTERPRISE PROVE THAT THE BOUNDARY HELD.**

- ✓ Authorized
- ✓ Bounded
- ✓ Enforceable
- ✓ Evidenced
- ✓ Testable
- ✓ Forensible



**The Futurist's
Strategy Cone™**
Strategic Direction. Aligned Execution.
Assured Outcomes.

Adnan Shamim

Creator of The Futurist's Strategy Cone™
and The I-A-N-E-T-F Cone™ Framework
Founder of The First Agentic AI Audit Ecosystem™

AI enhances capability.
Humans maintain accountability.
Boundaries define trust.
Assurance proves it.

AI adoption is accelerating.

Enterprise AI maturity is not.

That gap is where risk lives.

And with Agentic AI, the stakes are higher.

Because **capability** $\neq$ **authority**.

An agent may be technically capable of taking an action.

That does not establish that the action is authorized.

The real governance question is not:

“Can the AI do it?”

It is:

“What is the intended action, who has the authority to authorize it, what decision boundary governs it, what evidence proves the decision, and can the control be tested, enforced, and—when required—revoked?”

That is the difference between **AI capability** and **controlled AI execution**.

Responsible Agentic AI cannot rely on policy statements or human oversight alone.

It requires an assurance chain that establishes:

Intent.

Authority.

Enforcement.

Evidence.

Testing.

Forensic.

The objective is not to prevent AI from acting.

It is to ensure that consequential AI actions remain **authorized, bounded, enforceable, evidenced, testable, and accountable.**

Because the ultimate question is not:

“What can the agent do?”

It is:

“What is the agent authorized to do—and can the enterprise prove that the boundary held?”



ADNAN SHAMIM

AGENTIC AI GOVERNANCE

INTERNAL AUDIT ECOSYSTEM™



TWO COMPLEMENTARY FRAMEWORKS. TWO DISTINCT PURPOSES. ONE ACCOUNTABILITY ARCHITECTURE.

STRATEGY DEFINES WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN.
ASSURANCE INDEPENDENTLY EVALUATES WHETHER IT OPERATED AS INTENDED—
AND WHETHER SUFFICIENT **EVIDENCE** SUPPORTS THAT CONCLUSION.

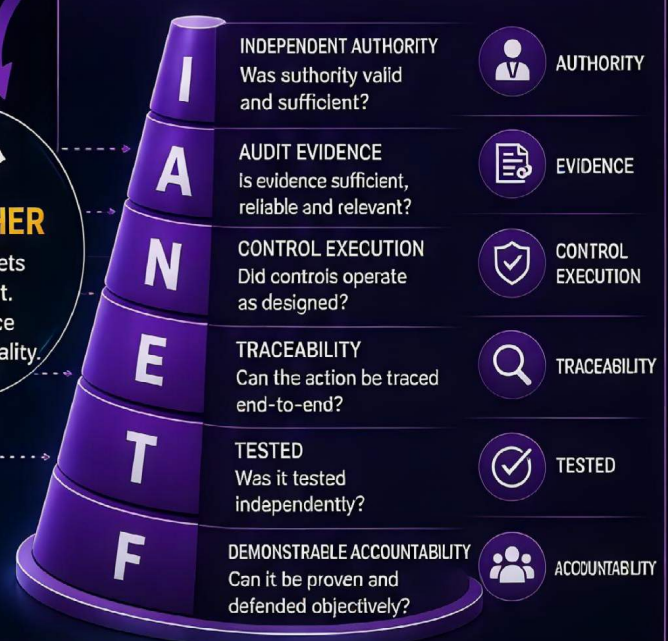
THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

Structures Agentic AI strategy, decision boundaries, operating models, execution, and human accountability.



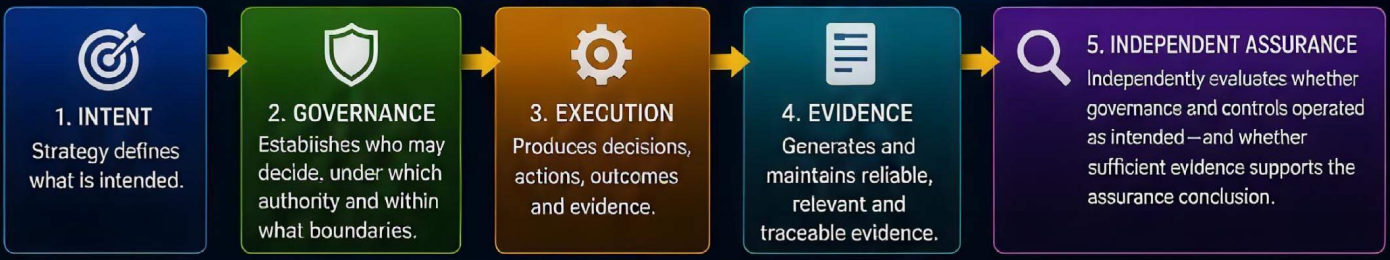
THE I-A-N-E-T-F CONE FRAMEWORK™

Structures independent assurance around authority, evidence, control execution, traceability, and demonstrable accountability.



TOGETHER
Strategy sets the intent.
Assurance validates reality.

THE DISTINCTION IS FUNDAMENTAL



WHAT THIS ECOSYSTEM ENSURES

- ✓ Clear separation of Strategy (Management) and Assurance (Internal Audit).
- ✓ Defined decision boundaries and human oversight.
- ✓ End-to-end traceability and immutable evidence.
- ✓ Independent evaluation, testing, and assurance.
- ✓ Demonstrable and defensible accountability.



NOT A REPLACEMENT

Does not replace management accountability, governance, risk management, internal controls, or independent professional judgment.

WHAT THIS ECOSYSTEM DOES NOT DO

- ✗ Does not replace management accountability.
- ✗ Does not replace governance, risk management, internal controls, or compliance functions.
- ✗ Does not guarantee outcomes or eliminate risk.
- ✗ Does not limit professional judgment or audit independence.



THE OBJECTIVE IS NOT TO ASSUME CONTROL.
IT IS TO DEFINE IT, GOVERN IT, OPERATE IT,
EVIDENCE IT, TEST IT, AND INDEPENDENTLY ASSURE IT.



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Internal Audit & AI Governance Professional
Creator of:

- The Futurist's Strategy Cone™
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Driving Responsible Agentic AI
Through Strategy, Governance
and Independent Assurance.



SCAN TO EXPLORE
THE FRAMEWORKS